Yılmaz Tarık İpekçi

Game Developer — Unity (C#) & Unreal Engine 5 (C++/Blueprint)

Istanbul, Turkey (UTC+3, CET/CEST hours OK) | +90 534 589 92 50 | ytarik.ipekci@gmail.com
tarikipekci.com | github.com/tarikipekci | linkedin.com/in/tarikipekci

SUMMARY

Game developer with 3 years of experience shipping gameplay, UI, and systems work on three released Steam titles. I work in Unity (C#) and Unreal Engine 5 (C++/Blueprint), building everything from multiplayer networking and AI to the HUD and menus players actually touch. Strongest in simulation and survival genres, and comfortable owning a feature end to end, from prototype to shipped build. Based in Istanbul; available on-site or remote, CET/CEST hours.

SKILLS

Engines: Unity (C#, Unity 6), Unreal Engine 5 (C++/Blueprint) **Languages:** C#, C++, Java, C
Gameplay & Systems: Inventory, crafting, building, save/load, day-night cycle, resource management, procedural & endless levels
Multiplayer: Netcode for GameObjects, Steam Online Subsystem (Steam OSS), state synchronization
AI & Combat: Behavior Trees & Blackboards (custom nodes), Gameplay Ability System (GAS)
UI/UX: HUD & gameplay UI, custom UI elements, localization **Performance:** Object pooling, data tables, LODs, memory optimization
Editor Tooling: Editor Utility Widgets, pipeline automation **Source Control:** Git, SVN, Diversion
AI-Assisted Development: Claude and ChatGPT for code generation, debugging, and day-to-day workflow
Practices & Tools: SOLID principles, design patterns, Jira, Notion, Miro

WORK EXPERIENCE

Hiraru Games — Game Developer *Feb 2026 – Apr 2026 | Remote*
Zoo Life Simulator (Steam Early Access). Worked alongside fellow programmers, level designers and game designers.

- Built a networked dirt system for Zoo Life Simulator's animal enclosures: materials get progressively grimier over time and stay in sync for every player in the session.
- Built a decoration system for placing props around the zoo, using collision checks to keep placement clean.
- Added client-side flying birds along set paths across the map for atmosphere, and resolved build-stability bugs along the way.

Independent — Mobile Game Developer (Unity) *Sep 2025 – Jan 2026 | Istanbul*

- Built mobile games solo in Unity (C#) full-time, owning everything from core mechanics to UI and polish.

Visma Games — Game Developer *Mar 2025 – Sep 2025 | Remote*
The Pub Life Simulator (Steam Early Access).

- Built the Cleaning and Tutorial systems for The Pub Life Simulator, working across a hybrid C++ and Blueprint pipeline from first pass through ship.
- Implemented Behavior Tree AI with custom nodes, along with UI, save/load, and dynamic material logic.
- Raised frame rate 2 to 2.5x by reducing tick rates, simplifying collision, optimizing AI, and tuning LODs and textures, and introduced object pooling and data tables to keep game data scalable.

Double Barrel Games — Game Programmer *Jun 2023 – Feb 2025 (Part-time → Full-time) | Istanbul*
HELLBREAK, on Steam.

- Built the game's HUD and core UI in C++/Blueprint: off-screen enemy direction indicators, health bar, collected-souls counter, and a skill cooldown system with its UI.
- Diagnosed and fixed enemy movement and ability bugs, tightening gameplay responsiveness through iterative feature passes.
- On the project from before the first demo, through both the demo and Early Access launches, handling ongoing UI and bug work as the game evolved.

INTERNSHIPS

Tigloos Games — Game Programmer Intern *Jul 2024 – Aug 2024 | Istanbul*

- Programmed a procedural-grid chessboard system in UE5 (C++/Blueprint) with rule-based spawning and state control.
- Prototyped an RTS with resource management, modular building placement, unit control and Behavior Tree AI.

Veri Bilgi Merkezi — Software Engineer Intern *Jul 2023 – Aug 2023 | Istanbul*

- Built an RPA tool for criteria-based data extraction, with auto-login, dynamic scraping and structured Excel export.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Unannounced Co-Op Zombie Defense — Unreal Engine 5 *In development, heading to Steam*

- 4-player co-op zombie defense with working Steam multiplayer and a playable demo already in testers' hands. Physics-driven combat (dismemberment, ragdoll chain reactions) and a wave mutation system keep runs from repeating.

RPG Combat System — Unreal Engine 5 (C++ & GAS) GitHub

- Combat framework built on Unreal's Gameplay Ability System: ability activation, cooldowns and attribute-driven damage handled in C++.

Level Asset Analyzer — UE5 Editor Tool GitHub

- Editor Utility Widget that audits Static Mesh Actors for triangles, materials and collision complexity, sorts them into poly-count folders, flags duplicate meshes, and raises tiered performance warnings.

Co-Op Survival (Senior Project) — Unreal Engine 5 GitHub

- Third-person co-op survival with inventory, crafting, building, a day-night cycle and enemy AI. Steam OSS keeps up to 4 players synchronized, with a full HUD on top.

Co-Op Survival 2D — Unity GitHub

- Online zombie survival with 4-player multiplayer over Netcode for GameObjects, dynamic wave spawning, varied enemy AI, and an upgrade system built on a SOLID architecture.

Ranch Gallop — Unity GitHub

- 3D endless runner built and shipped solo, start to finish: a procedurally generated infinite level with tile destruction tuned to keep memory flat and frame rate steady on both PC and mobile.

Also on GitHub: Tower Defense, Animal Match (match-3) and Fox's Tale (2D pixel-art platformer), all in Unity.

EDUCATION

Karabük University — B.Sc. Computer Engineering *2020 – 2024*

ACHIEVEMENTS

- KBU Game Experts (Nov 2022 – Sep 2024): selected 1 of 7 from 200 students for the university's game-dev group.
- Lab Assistant, Karabük University (Nov 2023 – Jan 2024): appointed by faculty to support programming courses.

LANGUAGES

Turkish (Native) | English (Professional) | Japanese (Beginner)